

Audit of the Ideal Person Curriculum

Executive summary

I reviewed the 22-domain, 259-competency YAML curriculum as a model of “ideal” personhood and also looked at the handwritten precursor materials to understand what was abstracted away during generalization. Those precursor notes make the lineage clear: the system began as a much more personal, type-driven, and sometimes gendered or status-coded framework, then evolved into a more universalized curriculum. That shift is real and substantial. [filecite\turn0file2](#) [filecite\turn0file3](#) [filecite\turn0file4](#)

At the declared abstraction level, the curriculum is **unusually broad and serious**. It clearly covers all six domains in Harvard’s flourishing framework—happiness/life satisfaction, mental and physical health, meaning and purpose, character and virtue, close social relationships, and financial/material stability—and it also tracks the older WHO view that health is not merely absence of disease but includes physical, mental, and social well-being. Your taxonomy goes further than those models by adding civic life, household competence, safety, work, money, creativity, play, mortality, and legacy. In plain terms: this is not a narrow self-help checklist; it is a full-stack human development curriculum. ¹

It also maps strongly onto major virtue and wisdom traditions. Aristotle’s ethics emphasizes flourishing through virtuous activity, habituation, practical wisdom, friendship, and the role of external goods; Stoicism emphasizes discipline of judgment, self-command, mortality, and distinguishing what is and is not “up to us”; Confucian ethics emphasizes benevolence, righteousness, ritual propriety, trustworthiness, education, family roles, and moral example. Large portions of the curriculum line up cleanly with all three. ²

The religious overlap is also real. Biblical and Jewish sources emphasize justice, mercy, humility, loving-kindness, faithfulness, and self-control; Islamic teaching centrally stresses justice, ihsan, patience, and moral restraint; Buddhist sources stress right action, mindfulness, loving-kindness, and role-based duties of household life; the Bhagavad Gita emphasizes dharma, equanimity, self-mastery, compassion, and devotion. The curriculum includes all of those families of concern, though it frames them in a modern, pluralist, reflective style rather than from inside any one orthodox tradition. ³

Against modern self-improvement frameworks, the curriculum strongly overlaps with James Clear’s identity-based habit model and FranklinCovey’s 7 Habits, especially around identity, environment design, clarity of ends, prioritization, empathic listening, renewal, and principled action. It also overlaps partially with current products such as Fabulous, Rosebud, Mindsera, and Rocky.ai, but all of those products cover only slices of what your curriculum attempts: routines, journaling, reflection, AI coaching, goal-tracking, or emotional support. None of them approaches your model’s combined breadth across virtue, spirituality, civic duty, family, domestic competence, money, mortality, and legacy. ⁴

The main problem is not lack of breadth. The main problem is **claiming universality too strongly**. Major traditions disagree about the ideal human end: Aristotle ties flourishing to virtuous activity and some external goods; Stoics hold virtue sufficient; Kant centers duty and respect for humanity; Mill centers utility

and limits on coercion; Nietzsche is suspicious of conventional morality and prizes self-overcoming and affirmation. Because those disagreements are basic and not superficial, no single curriculum can honestly be called a final, culture-free model of “perfect personhood.” Your curriculum can, however, be defended as a **late-modern, pluralist, ethically thick model of flourishing, competence, and responsibility**. That is a serious claim and a defensible one. ⁵

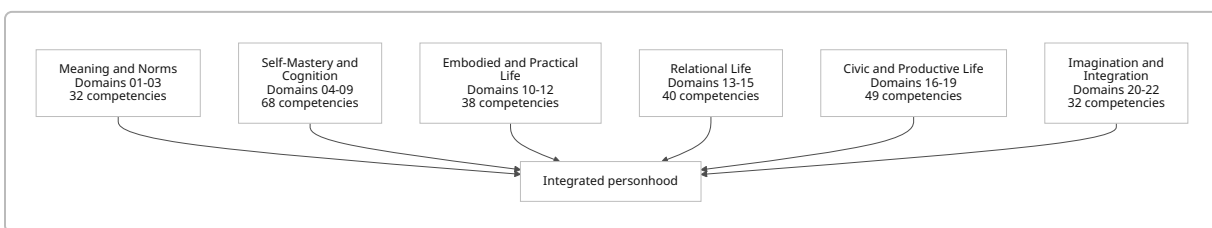
My bottom-line judgment is this: **as a broad curriculum of adult flourishing and capability, it is plausibly near-complete; as a universal model of “the perfect person,” it is not fully defensible without major qualification**. Breadth is a major strength. Normative finality is the weakness.

Method and evaluative lens

I audited the curriculum at the level it claims to operate: not as a set of micro-habits, and not as a psychometrically validated personality instrument, but as a **master-competency taxonomy** for human formation. That means the right question is not “does it include every possible task?” but “does it cover the major genres of human flourishing, virtue, agency, relationship, embodiment, social responsibility, and transcendence at a coherent level of abstraction?” That is also the level at which major virtue traditions and flourishing frameworks usually operate. ⁶

I used five lenses. The first was classical philosophy: Aristotle, Stoicism, Confucius, Plato, Kant, Mill, and Nietzsche. The second was canonical religion: Christianity/Bible, Islam, Judaism, Buddhism, and Hinduism. The third was modern self-change frameworks such as Atomic Habits and the 7 Habits. The fourth was psychology and development: SDT, Big Five-related social-emotional frameworks, emotional intelligence, and flourishing research. The fifth was product comparison: Fabulous, Rosebud, Mindsera, and Rocky.ai. ⁷

The curriculum’s internal center of gravity is also visible if the 22 domains are grouped into larger families:



That map reveals one important structural truth: the curriculum is **heavily weighted toward self-mastery, cognition, and executive function**. That is not necessarily wrong, but it does shape the kind of “ideal person” the curriculum implicitly imagines: disciplined, reflective, competent, organized, relationally aware, and socially responsible. It is much less oriented toward ecstatic spirituality, radical dependence, disability-centered life design, communal liturgy, or tragic endurance as central rather than marginal modes of human excellence. That bias becomes important in the final verdict.

Cross-framework mapping

Across traditions, your curriculum covers the “big invariants” of moral formation better than most frameworks do on their own. Aristotle gives you flourishing, habituation, phronesis, friendship, and the

need to order external goods; Stoicism gives you inner governance, reality contact, mortality, and disciplined assent; Confucianism adds role ethics, family obligations, trustworthiness, ritual, and education. Because your taxonomy includes meaning, values, moral perception, virtue, self-knowledge, discipline, reasoning, friendship, partnership, citizenship, work, and legacy, it captures much of the overlap among those three traditions. ²

The Abrahamic traditions bring a different emphasis: justice, mercy, humility, faithfulness, care for the vulnerable, truthfulness, stewardship, prayer or devotion, and accountability before something higher than the isolated self. The curriculum includes all of those themes, especially in the ethics, spirituality, caregiving, community, money, and legacy domains. Its strongest fit here is not doctrinal but ethical-practical: it fits the moral shape of these traditions more than their metaphysical exclusivism. ⁸

Buddhist and Hindu sources strengthen another part of the map: mindfulness, craving, right action, loving-kindness, household duties, equanimity, dharma, role-appropriate action, and freedom from egoic attachment. Those are clearly present in your attention, emotional maturity, sexuality, caregiving, spirituality, and integration domains. ⁹

Modern self-help frameworks mostly cover only the “operating system” layer. James Clear emphasizes identity-based habits, environment design, and consistency. The 7 Habits emphasizes personal responsibility, purpose, prioritization, empathic understanding, synergistic cooperation, and renewal. Your curriculum fully absorbs those ideas, but it also adds the thicker moral and civilizational layers that those frameworks usually omit. That is one of its genuine advantages. ¹⁰

Psychology and flourishing research confirm part, but not all, of the structure. SDT says that autonomy, competence, and relatedness are universal psychological needs. OECD’s social-emotional framework organizes much of everyday functioning around Big Five-related competencies such as conscientiousness, emotional stability, agreeableness, open-mindedness, and engaging with others. Emotional-intelligence research adds perceiving, understanding, and managing emotion. Harvard’s flourishing work pulls meaning, virtue, relationships, health, and financial stability into the same picture. Your curriculum clearly covers all of those domains, but then extends into areas that psychology alone usually leaves normatively underspecified: spirituality, domestic competence, citizenship, sexuality, money stewardship, beauty, and legacy. ¹¹

This leads to the fairest summary of the framework: **it is not merely a virtue curriculum, not merely a happiness curriculum, not merely a self-help program, and not merely a life-skills taxonomy. It is an attempted synthesis of all four.** That synthesis is the reason it feels unusually comprehensive. It is also the reason it becomes philosophically contestable.

Domain-by-domain audit

The table below is a domain-level synthesis. “Evidence strength” refers to how strong the empirical and measurement base is for that kind of competency in psychology, health, education, or organizational research—not whether the domain is morally important. The source lens for the mappings below includes Aristotle, Stoicism, Confucius, Kant, Mill, Nietzsche, canonical religious texts, SDT, OECD social-emotional skills, emotional-intelligence research, Harvard flourishing, WHO health, James Clear, FranklinCovey, and current app/product documentation. ¹²

Domain	Major source alignment	Coverage judgment	Main gap, redundancy, or bias note	Evidence strength
Meaning, Worldview, and Purpose	Aristotle, 7 Habits, Harvard flourishing, Gita	Strong	Very good on orientation and purpose; lighter on tragedy, absurdity, and meaning after catastrophic loss	Medium
Ethics, Virtue, and Integrity	Aristotle, Kant, Mill, Micah, Qur'an	Strong	Excellent normative core; could add explicit nonviolent resistance/civil disobedience	Medium
Spirituality, Religion, Mortality, and Transcendence	Abrahamic traditions, Buddhism, Hinduism, Stoic memento mori	Strong	Broadly plural, but framed through modern reflective individualism more than thick communal orthodoxy	Low-Medium
Self-Knowledge, Identity, and Humility	Socratic/Kantian self-scrutiny, Big Five, narrative identity	Strong	Good on labels-as-lenses; thin on disability, neurodiversity, and embodied identity from the first-person perspective	Medium
Emotional Maturity, Resilience, and Mental Well-Being	EI research, SDT, flourishing science	Strong	One of the best domains; should state trauma/PTSD and chronic dysregulation more explicitly	High
Attention, Desire, Temperance, and Discipline	Stoicism, Buddhism, Atomic Habits	Very strong	Powerful and coherent, but slightly overweights ascetic self-control relative to playfulness and dependence	High
Reasoning, Truth, Judgment, and Decision-Making	Plato, Kant, Mill, OECD	Very strong	Strong epistemic core; could more explicitly include statistics, scientific reasoning, and AI-generated misinformation	High
Learning, Memory, Curiosity, and Teaching	Confucian learning, learning science, OECD	Very strong	Excellent and measurable; tacit apprenticeship/ community transmission could be stronger	High

Domain	Major source alignment	Coverage judgment	Main gap, redundancy, or bias note	Evidence strength
Time, Priorities, Goals, and Execution	7 Habits, Atomic Habits, modern execution systems	Strong	Useful but somewhat overrepresented given overlap with discipline and integration domains	Medium–High
Physical Health, Fitness, and Embodiment	WHO, Harvard flourishing, preventive health	Very strong	Strong domain; could better include chronic illness adaptation, pain, and disability-centered excellence	High
Practical Independence, Home, and Material Life	Household stewardship, adult functioning	Strong	Very practical; assumes some institutional stability, housing security, and middle-class control over environment	Medium
Safety, Preparedness, Risk, and Survival	Public health, risk management, civic readiness	Strong	Good scope; mutual-aid/ community disaster competence could be more explicit	Medium–High
Communication, Rhetoric, and Social Intelligence	Classical rhetoric, EI, 7 Habits Habit 5	Very strong	Excellent domain; style presumes relatively direct Western communication norms	Medium–High
Friendship, Belonging, Hospitality, and Networks	Aristotle, Harvard relationships, SDT relatedness	Strong	Strong on selection, reciprocity, and loneliness; somewhat individualistic relative to clan/community cultures	Medium
Love, Sexuality, Partnership, Family, and Caregiving	Attachment, household ethics, Sigalovada, care traditions	Strong	Strong overall; could expand fertility, reproductive ethics, and diverse family forms	Medium
Community, Citizenship, Justice, and Service	Plato, Mill, Kingian nonviolence, WHO social well-being	Strong	Good public dimension; could add more explicit propaganda resistance, media institutions, and nonviolent organizing	Medium

Domain	Major source alignment	Coverage judgment	Main gap, redundancy, or bias note	Evidence strength
Work, Craft, Professionalism, and Contribution	Confucian role ethics, 7 Habits, organizational excellence	Strong	Strong on capability and contribution; labor exploitation and worker-protection ethics are lighter than employer/producer ethics	Medium
Leadership, Power, Mentorship, and Institutions	Plato, Confucian moral example, institutional stewardship	Strong	Strong domain; anti-corruption, capture, and abuse-of-power mechanics could be sharper	Medium
Money, Business, and Resource Stewardship	Harvard financial stability, stewardship traditions, modern finance	Strong	Broad and practical; macro-political economy and social insurance literacy remain modest	Medium
Creativity, Beauty, and Culture	Nietzschean self-fashioning, aesthetic literacy, moral imagination	Strong	Valuable and often missing from self-help; hardest domain to standardize and validate empirically	Low–Medium
Play, Leisure, Nature, and Exploration	Positive psychology, awe, restoration, Sabbath-like rest	Strong	Good corrective to productivity culture; could better include communal festivity and celebration	Medium
Integration, Life Design, Seasons, and Legacy	Aristotle's practical wisdom, 7 Habits, Harvard flourishing	Strong	Necessary capstone, but overlaps with meaning, priorities, and review domains	Medium

Compared with current consumer and AI-enabled personal-growth products, the taxonomy is substantially broader. Fabulous concentrates on routines, behavioral-science habit formation, and guided programs; Rosebud and Mindsera center journaling, pattern recognition, and reflection; Rocky.ai emphasizes AI coaching, goal-tracking, workplace development, and roleplay. That means the curriculum is not redundant with what is already on the market; it is **broader than the market's standard product surface**. On the other hand, that same breadth makes it harder to measure, teach, or productize without simplification. ¹³

Missing competencies, overrepresented areas, and taxonomy changes

The curriculum's biggest weakness is not omission of obvious life categories. It is **underrepresentation of certain conditions of human limitation**, especially where personhood is shaped less by mastery and more by constraint, dependence, or structural vulnerability.

The most important missing or underweighted areas are these:

Priority	Missing or thin area	Why it matters
Highest	Trauma, PTSD, and recovery after violation	Trauma changes attention, trust, embodiment, memory, attachment, and safety behavior; it is not just a special case of emotional maturity
Highest	Disability, chronic illness, pain, and neurodiversity as lived identity	A universal model needs to account not only for caregiving toward others, but for selfhood under durable limits
High	AI literacy, algorithmic environments, and epistemic defense in digital life	Modern judgment increasingly happens inside feeds, recommendation systems, synthetic media, and AI assistants
High	Nonviolent civic action and conflict transformation	Justice and citizenship are present, but organized nonviolent change deserves clearer treatment
High	Receiving care, dependency, and seasons of reduced agency	The current model is strongest when the person is choosing, acting, and building; it is thinner when the person must endure, receive, or be cared for
Medium	Labor ethics and power asymmetry at work	The curriculum is stronger on professional excellence than on exploitation, precarity, and worker rights
Medium	Communal festivity, liturgy, and celebration	It has play and sacred time, but not enough on joy as shared culture rather than individual restoration
Medium	Reproductive life-course issues	Sexual ethics is present, but fertility, miscarriage, infertility, reproductive decision-making, and parenthood variation remain thinner

These gaps matter because major traditions and modern research both insist that flourishing is not only about agency and optimization. Harvard's flourishing work includes health, relationships, virtue, meaning, and material stability; SDT treats autonomy as only one of three universal needs alongside competence and relatedness; WHO explicitly embeds social well-being in its health definition. A model that overweights self-command while underweighting dependency, accommodation, and care will systematically misdescribe some real human lives. ¹⁴

There are also overrepresented zones. The curriculum has **a lot** of surface area in discipline, execution, review, and organized self-management: attention audit, habit design, consistency, goal decomposition, project planning, operating reviews, annual reckoning, and life architecture all pull in the same direction. That is not dead weight, but it does indicate a managerial or engineering bias. By comparison, awe, ritual, grief, reconciliation, and communal joy are thinner. That asymmetry is philosophically meaningful: it pushes the model closer to "high-functioning responsible adult" than to a truly balanced anthropology. ¹⁵

The main cultural and normative biases are these:

The first is **liberal-individualist bias**. The curriculum assumes self-authorship, explicit reflection, chosen values, direct negotiation, and periodic self-review. That fits modern Western, educated, institutionally stable contexts very well. It fits cultures organized more by inherited roles, communal identity, ritual duty, or tacit custom less well. Confucian and many religious traditions do include self-cultivation, but they typically embed it more thickly in community, hierarchy, and ritual than your present framing does. ¹⁶

The second is **managerial bias**. Many competencies are written so they can be reviewed, tracked, operationalized, or optimized. That makes the curriculum teachable, but it can subtly flatten realities that are resistant to managerial control: grief, contemplation, beauty, holiness, dependence, and historical injustice.

The third is **late-modern bourgeois bias**. Household systems, budgeting, repair culture, preventive care, travel literacy, and professional reputation are all good and legitimate. But they presuppose an amount of institutional access, stability, and discretionary control not everyone has equally.

The taxonomy changes I would recommend are therefore surgical, not wholesale:

Recommendation	Change
Add one new domain	Vulnerability, Trauma, Disability, and Dependency
Split Domain 15	Separate Intimacy and Sexuality from Family, Parenting, and Caregiving
Split Domain 19	Separate Personal Finance and Stewardship from Entrepreneurship, Markets, and Economic Systems
Rename Domain 11	Change to Domestic Competence, Infrastructure, and Digital Life
Expand Domain 16	Add explicit competencies for nonviolent civic action, institution/media literacy, and AI-era propaganda resistance
Tighten Domains 06/09/22	Reduce duplication across discipline, planning, and integration; keep one capstone review layer
Expand Domains 10 and 04	Add explicit lenses on chronic illness, neurodiversity, pain, and adaptive excellence
Expand Domain 21	Add celebration, festivity, pilgrimage, and communal recreation

If you make those changes, the model becomes more defensible—not because it gets “bigger,” but because it becomes more honest about the difference between agency, receptivity, and constraint.

Measurement architecture and validation plan

The curriculum is conceptually strong enough to function as a **content ontology** now. It is **not yet ready to function as a fully validated universal assessment model**. Psychology gives you validated fragments—flourishing indices, social-emotional trait measures, basic-needs scales, emotional-intelligence models, and health indicators—but nothing on the market validates a 259-competency “ideal person” instrument as a

unified construct. That means the next question is not “is it true?” in the abstract. It is “can this be measured, taught, and revised without becoming arbitrary or culture-blind?” 17

The good news is that your YAML already contains one useful building block per competency: an “evidence of progress” field. That is exactly the right instinct. For rollout, each competency should be measured using one or more of seven evidence types: conceptual explanation, real-world application, behavioral adherence over time, external-observer feedback, artifact completion, objective performance/health indicators where appropriate, and longitudinal review. That mixed-methods approach is much more defensible than a single self-report quiz. The current OECD work on social-emotional skills also warns against assuming that frequent task performance automatically equals underlying competence; the same warning applies here.

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A companion appendix with a 259-row metric scaffold is available here:

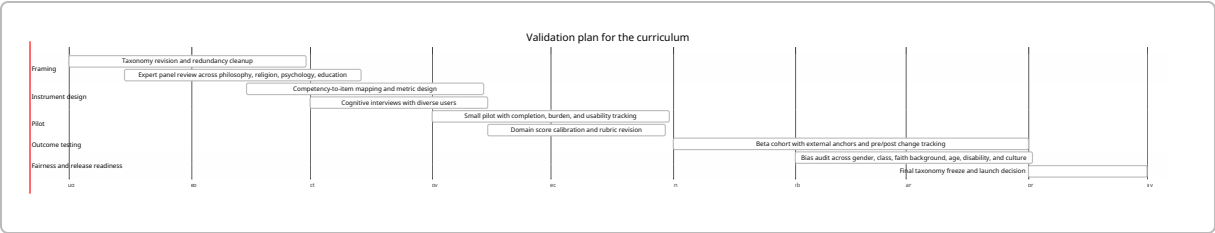
[Download the competency metrics appendix](#)

In practice, I would use the following external anchors when validating the curriculum:

External anchor	What it helps validate
Harvard Flourishing 12-question measure	overall well-being across meaning, character, relationships, health, and material stability
BPNSFS and SDT constructs	whether the model supports autonomy, competence, and relatedness
OECD social-emotional skill clusters	overlap with conscientiousness, emotional regulation, empathy, curiosity, trust, assertiveness, etc.
Health and prevention indicators	physical-functionality side of the model
Relationship-quality and social-support measures	friendship, partnership, and belonging domains
Artifact and behavior logs	execution, finance, safety, domestic competence, and review cycles

Those are not substitutes for your taxonomy; they are anchor points showing whether it tracks outcomes that reputable frameworks already treat as important. 19

A realistic 3–12 month validation plan would look like this:



The milestones I would care about most are simple and unforgiving. First, can experts from different traditions agree that the domain set is substantively complete enough for your stated purpose? Second, can ordinary users understand the competencies without feeling patronized or confused? Third, can participants reliably produce artifacts or behaviors that show movement, rather than only self-descriptions? Fourth, do domain scores correlate in sensible ways with flourishing, functioning, relationships, and health? Fifth, do some groups systematically score poorly because the taxonomy is culturally biased rather than because it is genuinely detecting a deficit? If you cannot answer those five questions well, you do not yet have a defensible “universal” model.

Final verdict

The strongest honest verdict is this:

Yes, the curriculum is plausibly “complete” at its own abstraction level as a broad, late-modern curriculum of human flourishing, competence, virtue, relationship, citizenship, and integration.

But also:

No, it is not fully defensible as a universal model of “perfect personhood” without qualification.

That is because “perfect personhood” is not a neutral category. Aristotle, Stoics, Confucians, Kantians, utilitarians, Buddhists, Hindus, Jews, Christians, Muslims, and Nietzscheans do not finally agree on the ideal human end, the relative priority of duty versus flourishing, the place of self-sacrifice, the role of external goods, the nature of freedom, or the meaning of suffering. A curriculum can unify a lot of overlap; it cannot erase those disagreements honestly. ²⁰

If I had to score it as it currently stands, I would call it:

Dimension	Score
Breadth of human coverage	9/10
Cross-tradition overlap	8/10
Practical usefulness as a curriculum	8/10
Taxonomic cleanliness	7/10
Empirical measurability	6/10
Cultural universality	5/10
Readiness to function as a validated assessment system	5/10

So the sharpest formulation is this:

The curriculum is **not** a final map of the perfect human. It **is** a strong candidate for a **comprehensive pluralist curriculum of adult flourishing and responsibility**. Tighten the duplication, add vulnerability/

disability/trauma and stronger digital-civic realism, and soften the universal claim. If you do that, the model becomes both more rigorous and more defensible.

1 14 17 19 <https://hfh.fas.harvard.edu/measuring-flourishing>

<https://hfh.fas.harvard.edu/measuring-flourishing>

2 5 7 12 20 <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/aristotle-ethics/index.html>

<https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/aristotle-ethics/index.html>

3 8 <https://www.biblegateway.com/verse/en/Micah%206%3A8>

<https://www.biblegateway.com/verse/en/Micah%206%3A8>

4 10 15 <https://jamesclear.com/identity-based-habits>

<https://jamesclear.com/identity-based-habits>

6 <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ethics-virtue/>

<https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ethics-virtue/>

9 <https://www.accesstoinsight.org/tipitaka/dn/dn.31.0.ksw0.html>

<https://www.accesstoinsight.org/tipitaka/dn/dn.31.0.ksw0.html>

11 <https://selfdeterminationtheory.org/the-theory/>

<https://selfdeterminationtheory.org/the-theory/>

13 <https://www.thefabulous.co/>

<https://www.thefabulous.co/>

16 <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/confucius/>

<https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/confucius/>

18 https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/survey-of-adult-skills-2023_3639d1e2-en/full-report/the-survey-of-adult-skills-and-the-measurement-of-human-capital_f320884e.html

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/survey-of-adult-skills-2023_3639d1e2-en/full-report/the-survey-of-adult-skills-and-the-measurement-of-human-capital_f320884e.html